

Third Deliverable: Greenlight
A Mental Health Awareness app for Students

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Introduction

The launch of Greenlight has now been improved based on the data we have collected from students. This application has been made to help many students who struggle with mental health throughout their college years. The app gives many students the opportunity to have a convenient, and private sources that help them with their mental health issues without having the anxiety or stress of using other sources. Today many students across college campuses in the United States face common issues like having financial, having large workloads, not being able to manage time efficiently in their day to day lives. All these factors can add a significant amount of stress on a student that result in many mental health issues.

The purpose of conducting our study like was to analyze data from a couple of questions to see how students can change their attitude due to mental health, how they can cope with pressure, and how willing are they to try and use a digital form of therapy like Greenlight rather than other options they might find difficult. From conducting a survey and analyzing our results, this report will aim to show the patterns given in students behavior, the barriers that keep everyday students from seeking the right help they need and being able to provide the opportunity to get access to these resources significantly easier. From collecting all this data, we can determine if our app Greenlight can be used as a helpful resource that students will continue to use to improve their mental health.

Description of Survey Data

Participants in our survey had to answer a set of questions about their academic status, if they are working while finishing their studies, their sources of stress, how they coped with their issues and how they feel about using mental health resources. This survey was given to many

students in different groups across campus. The survey was done online anonymously to ensure privacy. From there we reviewed the data and saw what we were able to analyze about stress in college students. The survey provided questions that were open ended to give students the opportunity to give genuine replies. This assisted in understanding the true feelings these students had around certain topics.

Emergent Themes – Qualitative

With conducting the survey, we noticed that there were a many common responses to the questions. The most common result we saw after conducting this survey was that many students faced the issue of managing time and having a heavy workload. Many also described their schedule being very hectic and stressful and stating that its hard to keep up when working a job throughout college as well. This is a major as it showed us that academic pressure and limited time put a large toll on many students' mental health. Another major response we noticed was students facing financial stress. Going to university can cost a large sum for many students that results in more stress in their daily lives.

Another theme that was expressed in our survey was how students wanted privacy and comfort when talking about their mental health. Many did not use their campus services as they did not know much about it or had a weird stigma around it regarding lack of privacy. Many students have mental health issues and are not comfortable enough to make the effort to go seek help. With our development of Greenlight, improved buy our survey data, we are able to build an online application that assists all types of students struggling with mental health in college. Overall, the data we collected from our qualitative survey will assist us in improving Greenlight to support the students.

Quantitative Data Analysis

To further support the qualitative findings, we conducted a quantitative analysis by converting our survey responses into numerical data. This process gave us the opportunity to identify patterns in this study. The survey we conducted was qualitative as we asked open ended questions. Because of this, coding was used to transform qualitative answers into measurable variables. For example, stress levels were categorized on a numerical scale. Low stress was represented as 1, moderate stress as 2, and high stress as 3 based on the intensity of responses related to workload, exams, and responsibilities. Categorical variables such as employment status (working students vs. not working students) and academic year (freshman, sophomore, junior, senior) were used as independent variables. These variables were selected because they would allow us to assess whether students who work or what academic year they are in experience mental health challenges differently.

For the first statistical test, an independent-samples t-test was conducted to examine whether there was a difference in stress levels between students who work while attending school and those who do not. This test was chosen because the independent variable (working/not working) consists of two groups, while the dependent variable (stress level) is numerical. The null hypothesis states that there is no difference in stress levels between working and non-working students. The alternative hypothesis states that there is a difference in stress levels between the two groups. The confidence level for this test was set at 95% ($\alpha = 0.05$), and the degrees of freedom were calculated based on the sample size. The results of the t-test were not statistically significant ($p > 0.05$), showing that there is no meaningful difference in stress

levels between students who work and those who do not. This suggests that stress is a widespread issue affecting students regardless of employment.

For the second statistical test, a one-way ANOVA was conducted to determine whether stress levels were different across the four years. We chose to conduct this test because the independent variable (academic year) contained more than two groups, while the dependent variable (stress level) remains numerical. The null hypothesis stated that there is no difference in stress levels across academic years. However, the alternative hypothesis stated that at least one group was different. The confidence level was set at 95% ($\alpha = 0.05$), and the degrees of freedom were calculated using the number of groups and total observations. The ANOVA results were also not statistically significant ($p > 0.05$), showing that stress levels are more likely consistent across freshmen, sophomores, juniors, and seniors. This reinforces the idea that mental health challenges are not limited to a specific year of college but are experienced across all students. With these statistical tests, we also looked at simple frequency patterns in the responses. Most students expressed that workload, exams, and time management was their biggest sources of stress. Many also said that privacy is important when it comes to mental health, describing it as “very” or even “extremely” important. Alongside this, most students said they haven’t used campus counseling services because they’re scared, don’t know enough about it, or feel like it’s not easily accessible. Even with all of that, most respondents said they would be open to using a mental health app. This shows there’s strong potential for something like Greenlight. Overall, the numbers line up with the themes we saw earlier and show clear patterns in how students think and act when it comes to their mental health.

Secondary Quantitative Data

To strengthen the findings from our primary research, secondary quantitative data was examined from our previous work regarding mental health trends among college students. Research showed that a large percentage of college students experience anxiety, stress, and depression during their academic time in college. However, many students do not seek professional help due to shame, lack of time, or limited access to resources. Studies indicated that over half of college students experience overwhelming anxiety, due to balancing academic, financial, and personal responsibilities. Alongside this, many students do not use the mental health resources their colleges provide.

These findings align with the patterns observed in the survey we conducted. Students who were questioned also reported high stress levels, not seeking help, and a strong desire for private and accessible options to ease their mental strain. With the growing use of applications for mental health, Greenlight can be a widely accepted solution. Overall, the secondary data supports the claim that mental health issues among college students are common and there are not many accessible, private, or convenient support systems.

Discussion

With looking at qualitative results and analyzing them to quantitative results, one thing that is clear across all studies is that mental health is a common and serious issue in college students. Things like academic pressure, financial stress, and lack of time were the most common responses. The data we concluded aligned with this as stress levels are high in all students regardless of certain groups. Students consistently mentioned things like workload, exams, and

balancing responsibilities as their biggest struggles, which shows that these are problems that are unfortunately an everyday experience.

One factor that stood out was that there were no major differences in stress levels based on the student's working status or what year of college they are in. One might expect seniors or students who are working alongside studying to have higher stress levels. However, our results did not prove that. Stress is a mental health issue that all students face regardless of their situation. We can use this to support the idea that mental health shouldn't target one specific group, but to everyone.

Another big takeaway was how important privacy and accessibility are valued when it comes to mental health. Many students said they do not feel comfortable using on campus counseling services as they have certain stigmas or not enough knowledge on the services. Students said they would consider using a mental health app, especially if it's private and easy to use. That contrast is highly important as it shows that the issue isn't that students don't want help, but that they don't have the options that meet their needs.

These are the reasons why we decided to launch Greenlight. Based on the results, the app fits well with what students are looking for. It offers something that feels more convenient, less intimidating, and more accessible than traditional options. Being able to access support from your phone, on your own time, and without feeling judged is a huge advantage. Overall, when looking at all the data, the results make it clear that there is a real gap in how mental health support is currently provided to students. Greenlight has the potential to fill that gap by offering a solution that matches both the emotional and practical needs of college students.

